Northwind Labs Benefits Guide

Plan Year 2026 | Total Rewards & Health Overview

1. Health & Medical Coverage Plans

Northwind Labs provides comprehensive medical coverage through BlueCross BlueShield with two plan options: the Premier PPO Plan and the High Deductible Health Plan (HDHP) with HSA. Northwind Labs covers 85% of monthly employee premiums and 75% of dependent premiums across both plans.

2. Premier PPO Medical Plan

Under the Premier PPO Plan, the individual annual in-network deductible is $500, and the family deductible is $1,000. In-network primary care office visits require a $25 copay, specialist visits require a $40 copay, and urgent care visits require a $50 copay. Generic prescription drugs carry a $10 copay, preferred brand names carry a $30 copay, and specialty medications carry a $60 copay. Annual out-of-pocket maximums are capped at $3,000 for individual coverage and $6,000 for family coverage.

3. High Deductible Health Plan (HDHP) & HSA Contribution

The HDHP features an annual in-network deductible of $1,500 for individuals and $3,000 for families. To support participants, Northwind Labs contributes $750 per year to an individual Health Savings Account (HSA) and $1,500 per year for family coverage, deposited in equal quarterly installments on the first payroll of each calendar quarter. HSA funds roll over indefinitely and are 100% owned by the employee.

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4. Dental Insurance via Delta Dental

Dental benefits are administered through Delta Dental PPO. Preventive care (cleanings, cleanings every 6 months, routine x-rays) is covered at 100% with no deductible. Basic restorative procedures (cavity fillings, extractions) are covered at 80% after a $50 deductible. Major services (crowns, bridges, dentures) are covered at 50%. The annual maximum dental benefit is $2,000 per insured member. Orthodontic treatment is covered at 50% with a separate lifetime maximum benefit of $1,500 for dependent children under age 19.

5. Vision Insurance via VSP

Vision care is insured through VSP Choice. Annual eye exams are covered in full after a $10 copay. Prescription eyeglass lenses are covered after a $25 materials copay. Northwind members receive an annual $200 frame allowance, plus a 20% discount on any frame costs exceeding $200. Elective contact lenses receive a $200 annual allowance in lieu of eyeglass lenses.

6. Life and Disability Insurance

Northwind Labs provides basic life insurance and Accidental Death & Dismemberment (AD&D;) equal to 2x annual base salary at no cost to the employee, up to a maximum benefit of $500,000. Short-term disability insurance replaces 60% of weekly pre-disability base salary up to $2,000/week for up to 26 weeks, starting on the 8th day of disability. Long-term disability replaces 60% of monthly salary up to $10,000/month after a 180-day elimination period.

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7. 401(k) Retirement Savings & Employer Matching

Our 401(k) retirement plan is administered through Fidelity Investments. Northwind Labs offers a 100% employer match on employee contributions up to 5% of eligible annual base salary. For instance, if you contribute 5% of your salary, Northwind matches another 5%, effectively doubling your savings. Employees may contribute on a pre-tax traditional 401(k) basis or after-tax Roth basis. Crucially, employer matching contributions feature 100% immediate vesting from day one of employment—there is no vesting schedule.

8. Wellness & Fitness Monthly Stipend

To support holistic health, Northwind Labs provides a taxable wellness reimbursement stipend of $75 per month ($900 annual maximum). Eligible expenses include commercial gym memberships, fitness studio classes (e.g., yoga, pilates, crossfit), sports league registration fees, personal athletic equipment, and digital mindfulness app subscriptions (such as Headspace or Calm). Reimbursement receipts must be submitted via Expensify by the 20th of each calendar month.

9. Flexible Spending Accounts (FSA)

Employees not enrolled in the HDHP/HSA plan may participate in a Healthcare Flexible Spending Account (FSA) up to the IRS annual limit ($3,200). A Dependent Care FSA is also available up to $5,000 per household annually for qualifying child care or elder care expenses.

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10. Tuition & Professional Learning Reimbursement

Northwind Labs invests actively in team skill development, offering up to $5,250 per calendar year in tuition and educational reimbursement. Eligible expenses include undergraduate and graduate courses at accredited academic institutions, professional technical certifications (e.g., AWS, Azure, PMP, CISSP), and approved industry conference admissions. To qualify for reimbursement, coursework must be pre-approved by your manager and HR prior to enrollment, and you must achieve a grade of 'B' or better (or 'Pass' in pass/fail grading).

11. Commuter & Transit Assistance

Employees may elect pre-tax payroll deductions up to $150 per month for qualified public transit passes, train fares, vanpools, and workplace parking. In addition, employees who regularly bicycle to work are eligible for an annual $100 bicycle tune-up and maintenance reimbursement credit.

12. Employee Assistance Program (EAP) via Lyra Health

Emotional well-being support is available 24 hours a day, 365 days a year through Lyra Health. Employees and their immediate household members are entitled to up to 6 confidential, fully covered mental health counseling sessions per issue per calendar year, accessible via in-person visits or secure video consultations.